

Outline

How do various factors identified in the European Quality of Life Survey (EQLS) influence happiness, and how do these findings compare to established psychological theories?

1. Introduction

1. Background

- Discuss the importance of understanding happiness and well-being in society.
- Overview of the European Quality of Life Survey (EQLS) and its significance in social research.
- Brief introduction to psychological theories related to happiness (e.g., Positive Psychology, Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs, Self-Determination Theory).

2. Goal of the Study

- To identify important factors influencing happiness using data from the EQLS.
- To analyze the importance of these factors using machine learning techniques (SHAP values).
- To compare the empirical findings with psychological theories and existing literature on happiness.

2. Psychological Research on Happiness

1. Overview of Happiness in Psychology

- Overview of how happiness is defined and measured in psychological research.

2. Major Psychological Theories on Happiness

- Positive Psychology
- Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs
- Self-Determination Theory

3. Previous Empirical Research on Factors Influencing Happiness

- Review of studies that have used similar surveys.
- Discussion of common factors.

3. Data and Methodology

1. Description of the European Quality of Life Survey.

- Overview of the data and the survey methodology.

2. Data Preparation

- Data cleaning and preprocessing steps.
- Explanation of which variables are used as features for machine learning.

3. Machine Learning Methods

- Introduction to machine learning techniques used.
- Explanation of SHAP values and how they will be used to assess feature importance.
- Statistical methods for validating results.

4. Results

1. Descriptive Statistics

- Presentation of key statistics and initial observations from the EQLS data.
- Use existing statistics from the EQLS website.

2. Results from Machine Learning Models
 - Summary of the performance of different models used to predict happiness.
3. SHAP Analysis
 - Detailed analysis of the SHAP values to identify the most important factors influencing happiness.
4. Key Findings
 - Discussion of the most influential factors and their relative importance.

5. Discussion

1. Comparison with theories mentioned in **2**.
 - Analyze how the findings compare to the psychological theories.
2. Limitations of the Study:
 - Acknowledgment of any limitations in the data, methodology, or scope of the study.
3. Suggestions for Future Research
 - Proposals for how future studies could build on these findings or address the limitations.

6. Conclusion

1. Summary of Findings
 - Recap the main findings of the study.
2. Contribution to the Field
 - Discuss how this research contributes to the understanding of happiness in psychology.

7. References